

suggesting that it is an easy job; it is an incredibly tough job. But the current system is not run well, and there are a lot of impediments to success in the system. Our goal is that there will be incentives for the public schools to adopt the things that we have done that have worked.

Have you seen any impact at all on the political side of things?

Lots of educators and legislators have visited our network's schools, and I think they have been flabbergasted. That's a great start. As we show more years of success, and because our goal is to share everything we are doing, I think we will have an influence.

Given the poor state of the current U.S. educational system, are you then optimistic that your efforts and similar efforts by others will lead to a meaningful improvement in the system within, say, the next 10 years?

That is the goal, but I also believe it will. We will play our small part, but there are plenty of other people following similar models. We share the intellectual property of anything we do that works, and we steal liberally from the most successful charter schools that work. The relevant question is not how well the average charter school performs, but rather whether some charter schools perform much better. The goal is finding those models that work and rolling them out in size. It is just like capitalism in general. You want to find winners and reproduce those.

But do you believe logic and results can overcome the political obstacles of the special interests?

Unfortunately, at the moment, the teachers union protests every new school we try to open because they don't want the competition. The teachers union's plan is to kill us with 1,000 cuts, which means opposing us every step of the way. If we can survive that onslaught, and we are still here in 10 years, which I think we will be, then the effect should be huge. If Eva can replicate the success they have had so far in 30 or 40 schools, it will help change the discussion. I think a lot has already been changed.

Have any politicians embraced what you're doing?

Although I have my disagreements with President Obama on a number of economic issues, for a Democrat, I think he has been very progressive on